

Finding your numbers on Yahoo Finance

A field-by-field walkthrough for the Financial Planner — three estimation methods, shown on real screenshots.

Everything the planner asks for can be found for free on finance.yahoo.com — no account, no premium subscription. You never do any maths by hand: you copy the numbers as they appear, and the program handles the rest (annualisation, CAGR, volatility). Throughout this guide we use one real product as the example: the iShares Core MSCI World UCITS ETF (IWDA.L), a global equity ETF. Every screenshot is from its actual page.

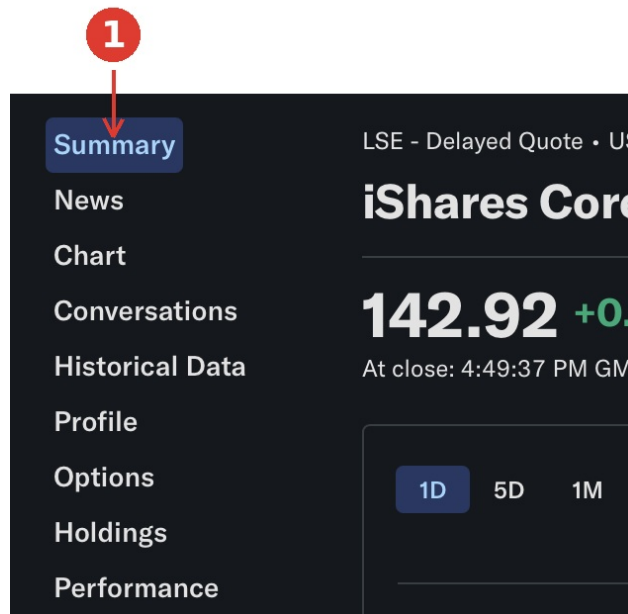
Term	What it means
Expected return	How much the investment is expected to grow per year on average (%), estimated from historical data.
Volatility	How much the value swings: the higher it is, the more outcomes can differ from the average (% per year).
TER	Total Expense Ratio — the fund's annual cost (%). On Yahoo it is "Expense Ratio (net)". It is subtracted from the return.
Capital-gains tax	Tax on the profit when you sell. In Italy it is 26% (12.5% only on government bonds).
Beta	How strongly a security amplifies market moves: 1 = moves with the market, above 1 = more, below 1 = less.

Data source: Yahoo Finance (finance.yahoo.com), free public pages. Example values: IWDA.L as of 20 July 2026.

GETTING STARTED

Find the product

Open finance.yahoo.com. In the search bar at the top, type the name, ticker or ISIN of the fund or stock (e.g. "IWDA", "Apple", "AAPL") and open its page. From there you use the left-hand column to move between sections — Summary, Profile, Risk, and so on.



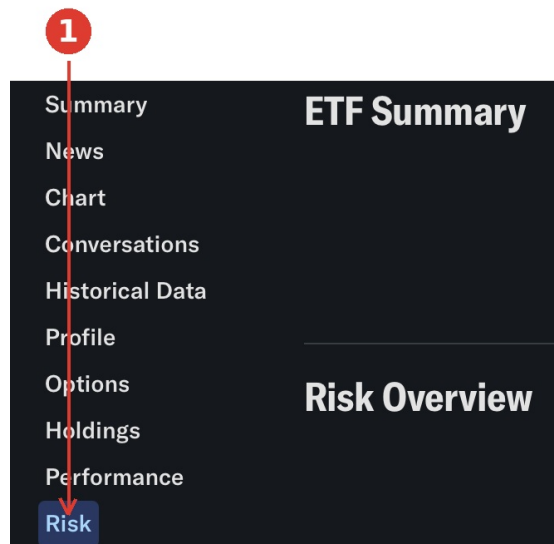
The left-hand navigation on any product page. Each method below tells you which section to open.

The time horizon you enter at the start of the program decides which column to read in Yahoo's tables: short the 3 Years column, medium 5 Years, long 10 Years. In the examples below the horizon is medium, so we always read the 5 Years column.

METHOD A

Risk Statistics tab

The simplest, most direct method for ETFs and funds. It takes two ready-made numbers from the Risk Statistics table.

Step 1 • Open the Risk section

In the left-hand column, click Risk (not “Summary”).

Step 2 • Read the two numbers

	3 Years			5 Years		
	IWDA.L	Category Average	IWDA.L	Category Average	IWDA.L	Category Average
Alpha	0.04	--	0.5	--	0.34	--
BETA	0.98	--	1.01	--	1.01	--
Mean Annual Return	1.54	--	1.01	--	1.13	--
R-squared	98.81	--	98.94	--	99.16	--
Standard Deviation	12.46	--	15.19	--	14.89	--

1

Pick the column for your horizon — here 5 Years (the “IWDA.L” sub-column, not “Category Average”).

2

Mean Annual Return = 1.01 copy it as shown. The program multiplies it by 12 (see note) = 12.12% / year.

3

Standard Deviation = 15.19 this is already the annual volatility in %. Copy it as shown.

Why ×12? Yahoo’s “Mean Annual Return”, despite the name, is the average of the monthly returns. To put it on an annual basis the program multiplies by 12. You never multiply anything yourself — just enter 1.01.

A note on the two return figures

The same page shows a second figure in the “Performance & Risk” box: 5y Average Return = 11.35%. It does not match $1.01 \times 12 = 12.12\%$, and that is not a mistake — the two measure different things.



The “5y Average Return” in the Performance & Risk box.

Mean Annual Return $\times 12$ (12.12%) is an arithmetic average of monthly returns.

5y Average Return (11.35%) is the compound annualised return (CAGR) over five years.

The compound figure is almost always slightly lower, because compounding accounts for the drag of volatility. In this method the program uses Mean Annual Return $\times 12$ — that is the current choice and is perfectly fine for an estimate.

METHOD B

Price history

Works for any stock or ETF, even when the Risk tab is not available. It is based on the Summary page.

Step 1 • Current price and 5-year chart



- 1 Current price = 142.92 (the large number at the top of the Summary page).
- 2 Open the chart and choose the 5Y range (or "All"), then hover over roughly five years ago and read the price back then. The program computes the annual growth (CAGR) itself.

Step 2 • Range and yield

Previous Close	142.82	Day's Range	142.55 - 143.53	Net Assets	--	YTD Daily Total Return	8.93%
Open	142.61	52 Week Range	117.26 - 161.35	NAV	142.54	Beta (5Y Monthly)	0.98
Bid	142.86 x 10008800	Volume	389,366	PE Ratio (TTM)	0.24	Expense Ratio (net)	0.20%
Ask	142.90 x 56100	Avg. Volume	398,102	Yield	0.00%		

- 3 52 Week Range = 117.26 – 161.35: the lowest and highest price of the last 12 months (past history, not today's price). Copy both — they estimate volatility.
- 4 Yield = 0.00%: the dividend paid, in %. For a stock this is "Forward Dividend & Yield".

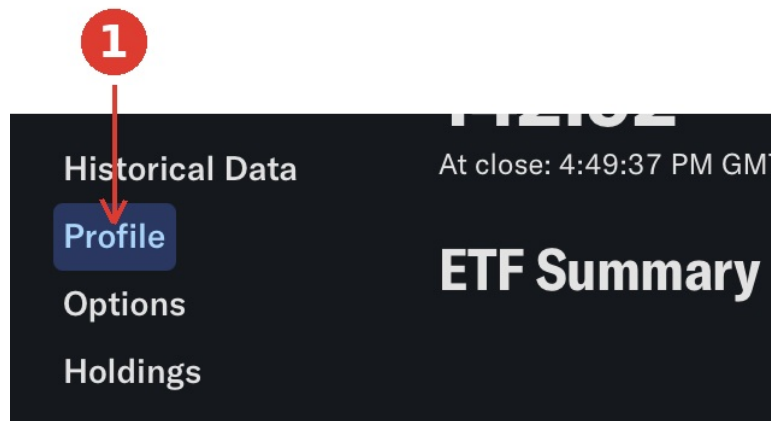
IWDA shows Yield 0.00% because it is an accumulating ETF: dividends are automatically reinvested inside the price. In that case enter 0, because the price growth (the CAGR) already includes them. For a security that pays dividends, enter the percentage shown.

ALL METHODS

TER and taxation

These two values do not depend on the method — the program asks for them once per asset.

TER • the fund's cost



Left-hand column: open Profile.

ETF Operations		Morningstar Style Box
Attributes	IWDAL Category Average	Yahoo partners with Morningstar a leading investment data group to help investors on Yahoo Finance. The Morningstar Capital
Annual Report Expense Ratio (net)	0.20% --	
Holdings Turnover	11.33% --	

1

In the ETF Operations section, find Annual Report Expense Ratio (net).

2

The value = 0.20%. This is the TER: the annual cost the fund retains. The program subtracts it from the return.

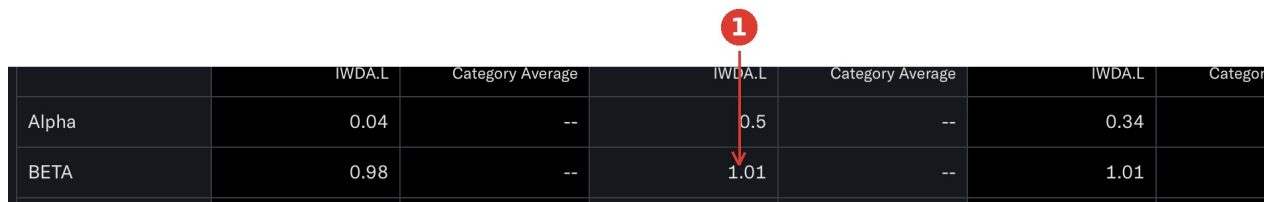
Capital-gains tax. This is not a Yahoo figure — it depends on your country. In Italy it is 26% on gains from stocks and ETFs (the exception is 12.5% on white-list government bonds). The program applies it only to the profit, at the time of sale. If in doubt, the default of 26% is correct for Italy.

METHOD C

CAPM – the market model

CAPM estimates the return from the Beta and the market return. It is most meaningful for individual stocks. You need four numbers: Beta, the risk-free rate, and the market's return and volatility.

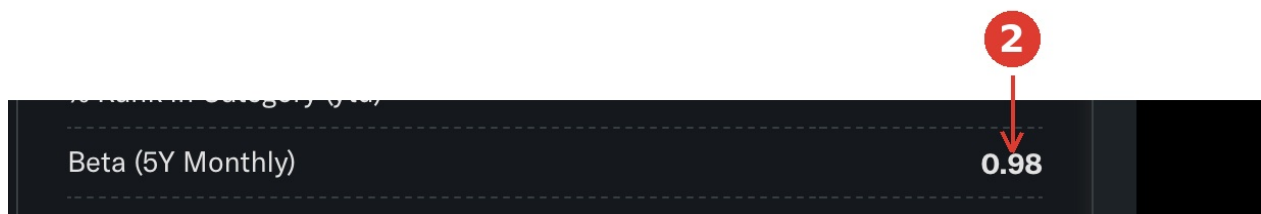
1 • Beta – same Risk tab as Method A



	IWDA.L	Category Average	IWDA.L	Category Average	IWDA.L	Category
Alpha	0.04	--	0.5	--	0.34	
BETA	0.98	--	1.01	--	1.01	

1

In the Risk Statistics table, 5 Years column, row BETA = 1.01.



Beta (5Y Monthly)	0.98
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2

Alternatively, the Performance & Risk box shows Beta (5Y Monthly) = 0.98. Either one is fine.

2 • Risk-free rate — the ^TNX index

This is the yield of the 10-year US Treasury, used as the “risk-free” return. Find it by searching the symbol ^TNX.



- 1** Type ^TNX in the search bar and click the first result, CBOE Interest Rate 10 Year T No.



- 2** The large number = 4.594. It is already a percentage: enter 4.59. (If you skip this field, the program uses 4% by default.)

3 • Market return and volatility

Yahoo does not publish “the market return” as a single figure. You read it exactly as in Method A, but on the page of an ETF that represents the market:

Market ETF	Represents
VOO or SPY	S&P 500 (500 large US companies)
URTH or IWDA	Global equity market

Open that ETF Risk 5 Years column and read, as in Method A: Mean Annual Return (the program multiplies by 12 market return) and Standard Deviation (market volatility). If you would rather not look them up, press Enter and the program uses the defaults of 8% and 15% per year.

You cannot use CAPM to estimate the return of a world index. A global ETF such as IWDA is the reference market: by definition its Beta is about 1. Applying CAPM to it means using the market to explain itself — the result would simply be the market return you started from, a circular and pointless calculation. That is why CAPM belongs to individual stocks, where Beta genuinely measures how much a stock amplifies the market. For a diversified ETF, rely on Method A or Method B instead.

SUMMARY

Which method to use

Situation	Recommended method
ETF or fund with a Risk tab available	Method A — the most direct
Any stock or ETF, always available	Method B
A single stock, analysed against the market	Method C (CAPM)
A global equity ETF (e.g. IWDA)	Method A or B — never CAPM

Disclaimer. All estimates are based on past returns over the chosen horizon. Past returns are not indicative of future returns. Investing for the long term is recommended where possible.

This guide is informational material and does not constitute financial advice. The values shown are examples taken from Yahoo Finance on the date indicated and change over time.